

# Care & Maintenance

## Routine cleaning and stain-removal guidance for DeckRite PVC membrane surfaces

### WHY THIS MATTERS

DeckRite requires far less maintenance than a traditional wood deck, but routine cleaning helps prevent dirt, sap, leaf residue and stains from becoming embedded. Start with the mildest cleaning method and thoroughly rinse the membrane after every cleaner.

## REGULAR CLEANING PROCEDURE

|          |                                                                                                                                                                          |
|----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> | <b>REMOVE LOOSE DEBRIS</b> Sweep or rinse away loose dirt, leaves, pine needles and other debris before washing.                                                         |
| <b>2</b> | <b>SATURATE AND APPLY SOAP</b> Wet the DeckRite surface with clean water. Apply approximately 2-3 tablespoons of mild dish soap per 100 sq. ft.; warm water may be used. |
| <b>3</b> | <b>SCRUB GENTLY</b> Use a soft-bristled deck brush or sponge mop. Work the soap and water over the surface, adding water as needed. Avoid aggressive scraping.           |
| <b>4</b> | <b>RINSE THOROUGHLY</b> Rinse completely with clean water so no soap or cleaner residue remains. Repeat the process if needed.                                           |
| <b>5</b> | <b>CLEAN REGULARLY</b> Perform routine cleaning three to four times per year, or as needed, and before winter or other extended periods of limited use.                  |

## CLEANER SELECTION BY CONDITION

| CONDITION                      | CLEANER / METHOD     | DIRECTIONS AND CAUTIONS                                                                                                                                                                |
|--------------------------------|----------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Ground-in dirt or minor stains | Citrus-based cleaner | Apply to a clean, dry rag and gently dab the stain. Test first in an inconspicuous area, then rinse thoroughly.                                                                        |
| Eco-friendly option            | Simple Green         | Spray the affected area, allow approximately 10 minutes of contact, wipe with a paper towel or soft cloth, and rinse.                                                                  |
| Tougher stains                 | Spray Nine           | Use as a non-bleaching option. Follow the product label, minimize contact time, test first, and rinse completely.                                                                      |
| Last resort                    | Tilex or CLR         | Use only if necessary. These products contain bleaching agents. Do not allow them to sit on the vinyl; rinse immediately. Extended contact may discolor or remove the printed pattern. |

### RECOMMENDED PRACTICES

- Begin with mild dish soap and water.
- Test stronger cleaners in a concealed area.
- Follow label directions and minimize contact time.
- Rinse completely after every cleaner.
- Contact DeckRite for stubborn or unusual stains.

### AVOID

- Allowing cleaners to dry or remain on the vinyl.
- Using harsh or bleaching products for routine care.
- Aggressive scraping or abrasive cleaning tools.
- Mixing cleaners or cleaning chemicals.
- Leaving sap, leaves or pine-needle residue in place.

**IMPORTANT:** Begin with the mildest method. Stronger or bleaching cleaners may alter the vinyl color or printed pattern.

This bulletin is intended as a maintenance reference. Always follow cleaner labels. Test first and contact DeckRite Technical Services for unusual stains or product-compatibility questions.